

Canon PIXMA MX318

Yay! For Features, Nay! For Performance

The PIXMA MX318 is the latest All-in-one (AIO) from Canon. It is a lustrous grey with a gloss finish, along with black; this MFD does not have the best build quality—particularly questionable are the trays.

The input tray can accommodate 100 sheets of paper—just enough for a SoHo setup. Print resolutions up to 4800 x 1200 dpi are supported, and the optical scanner resolution is 1200 x 2400 dpi—promising remarkably good print and scan quality. Sheet-fed as well as flatbed scanner options are available. A 30-sheet document feeder lies hidden until you flip it open.

The control panel is fairly simple to use, with buttons dedicated for each of the multiple functions. A single line mono LCD displays all the necessary status and settings information. It features PictBridge port, but the absence of memory card slots was conspicuous. It connects to the PC via a USB port, but there is no

network port. It supports high-speed Super G3 fax, with 20-destination auto-dialling; the fax memory of 50 pages is ample for most needs.

Print speed is very slow: it takes over half a minute to print black text at the best quality, while printing the combi-document takes over a minute at normal quality and well over hundred seconds at best quality. It is relatively faster at printing photos, taking just under four minutes for an A4 photo, and it does a good job at it with brilliant colours and good definition. The black text does not have clear edges, though it is not smudged. Combo documents are printed relatively better, the colour part in particular. It even manages to print yellow text against a black

RATINGS	
Performance	★★★★○
Features	★★★★○
Ease of Use	★★★★○
Value for Money	★★★○○
Overall	★★★★☆



background well. Black-and-white copying takes 28 seconds per page, while colour copying takes 41. It does a rather bad job at this, and the copies appear washed out.

Canon bundles along the Scansoft PaperPort application that lets you scan as well as manage documents. It even has OCR capability, thus saving you the cost of buying OCR software. Control Center 3 brings all the features of the MFD at your fingertips.

The Canon PIXMA MX318 has the features, but doesn't have the performance to back them up, and the considerably high price tag of Rs 10,995 does nothing to help things in its favour.

Specifications

Printer: Resolution: 4800 x 1200 dpi (effective); Input tray: 100 sheets

Scanner: Type: Flatbed and Sheet-fed; Resolution: 1200 x 2400 dpi (optical); Media size: A4; ADF: 30 sheets

Fax: Speed: 33.6 Kbps; Memory: 50 pages; Speed dialling: up to 20 numbers

General specifications:
 Dimensions: 46.5 (W) x 44 (D) x 23 (H) mm; Weight: 8.6 kg;
 Power consumption: Standby: 1.8 W; Off: 1.8 W; Max: 16 W

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Price: Rs 10,995

Intel D5400XS

Gross XS-es

If you thought Intel's latest X48 chipset was really something, wait till you see this—we got our socks knocked off and the tingle left behind in our toes was enough to assure us we were looking at something radically different. In fact, this motherboard is so new, there were no details of it on the Net as of this writing.

Presenting the
Skulltrail in its desktop
(yes, *Desktop*) avatar—Intel's

of ECC memory through four DIMMs and the ability to house two quad-core processors, the D5400XS is bound to leave a trail of skulls in its ponderous wake...

And it's a Desktop-oriented board too—with Intel's latest IDT STAC 9274D 8-channel HD-supporting audio codec, six SATA ports, two E-SATA ports, and even nifty add-ons like power and reset buttons, and an HDD



D5400XS—a consumer board featuring dual processor support, and four, SLI-capable PCIe graphics slots, among other things—but don't say that out loud. The D5400XS is based on Intel's MCP 5400 Northbridge (MCH), and a 6321ESB I/O ICH. Somewhere between lie two MCP 100s from NVIDIA—that's what enables SLI on this board.

With support for 16 GB

activity LED right on the board. There's also a two-digit POST (Power on Self Test) debugger. The BIOS is chock-full of overclocking options—CPU, memory and FSB overclocking and overvolting are supported, and strangely enough, recommended. All this makes the D5400XS one helluva desktop board, although its overclocking potential is yet to be seen. The reason we kept our

unlocked CPUs) was that at 3.2 GHz, we felt these quad-cores were close to their thermal limits. The thermal specs of these 45nm cores are even better than the G0 stepping Core 2 Quads we tested earlier, but we didn't want to push anything.

While you won't really appreciate the power of two processors with most regular tasks, if you're a 3D designer, animator or hardcore gamer, you will

Benchmarks	
W Prime (32M)	6.562
PC Mark 2005	
CPU	10208
Memory	5452
Graphics	11918
SiSoft Sandra 2007	
CPU Arithmetic (Dhrystone)	114876
CPU Arithmetic (Whetstone)	90840
CPU Multimedia (Integer)	682306
CPU Multimedia (Floating)	372881
3D Mark 2006:	
Doom 3 (640x480, 1600x1200, 4xAA, 4xAF)	247.6
Doom 3 (1600x1200, 4x AA, 8x AF)	200.6
Far Cry (640x480)	317.67
Far Cry (1600x1200, 4x AA, 8x AF)	154.59

shenanigans to a minimum (despite the fact that Intel helpfully provided us with

definitely appreciate the sheer horsepower at your fingertips. With multi-tasking or even multi-threaded applications, the difference astonishes—especially with the two QX9775 Core 2 Extreme processors, which are basically 45nm, 3.2 GHz quad-cores. Note that the pin layout on the board is slightly different—Socket 771 (LGA) CPUs are supported. (Regular Desktop CPUs are in the LGA 775-pin format.)

Check out our benchmarks (above) to see how this monster kicked hindquarters.

We don't expect the D5400XS to break any sales records—just benchmarks. This platform may just kick off in the workstation market, particularly for rendering machines, where the enormous multiprocessing CPU and GPU power will be harnessed better.

The entire platform is power-hungry. If you're looking at SLI, two quad-cores, and around three hard drives, opt for a 1000-watt power supply... Also invest in a decent air conditioner—and/or good aftermarket CPU coolers; these babies dissipate 150 watts each.

Buy this only if you can really afford to—at around Rs 25,000 for just the board, it's one of those luxuries that'll just add to your collection of nice things, right beside the Rolex and Porsche!

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